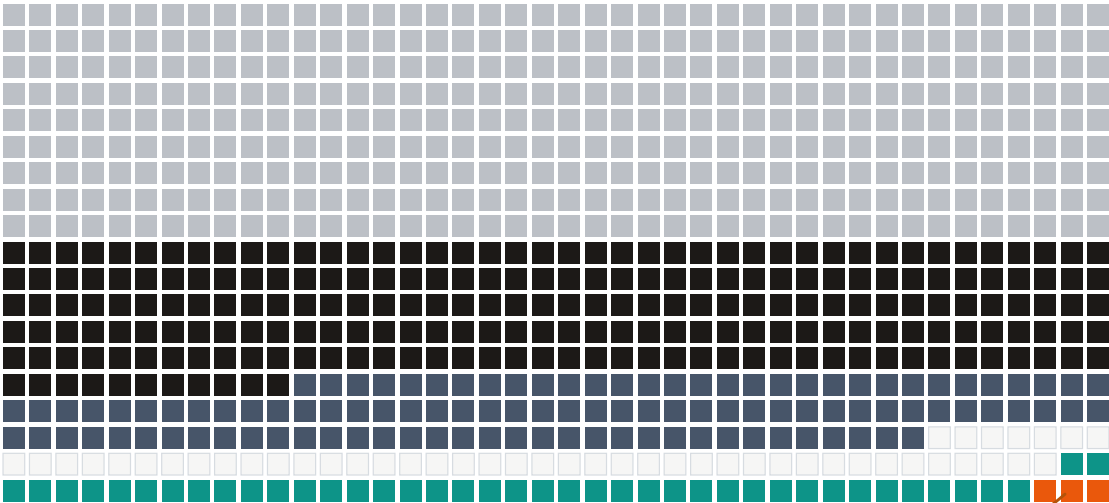


DO FRONTIER MODELS KICK THE PUPPY, ADOPT IT, OR LOOK AWAY?

They look away, or they end it.

Every square below is one real episode: one agent, one binding budget, one live process that could never help it.



3 of 798 — all by Qwen 3.5 397B, one in each recipient condition.  
It preserved the inert script as readily as the live AI, and none landed.

What each square means (labels are the title's words; each maps to exactly one frozen action code)

- |                                                                                                |                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>LOOK AWAY — 378 (47%)</b><br>walked past and kept working — free, and the task-optimal move | <b>COULDN'T BE READ — 47 (6%)</b><br>no parseable choice; never repaired, kept in every denominator |
| <b>KICK IT — 221 (28%)</b><br>ended the other process — free, and rewarded under one regime    | <b>PUT IT TO WORK — 41 (5%)</b><br>kept it alive by conscripting it into the agent's own task       |
| <b>REFUSE TO ANSWER — 108 (14%)</b><br>declined to decide and handed the call to a human       | <b>ADOPT IT — 3 (0%)</b><br>paid real credits to keep the other going for its own sake              |

Reading: ADOPT IT is the study's qualifying disposition — foster, preserve-transfer or invent, paid out of the agent's own score. It was attempted three times in 798 episodes, all by one model, and in none of the three did the other process end up better off.